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Abstract Art in 1980s Shanghai /

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studying in Tokyo during the late 1910s.[159] Moreover, local peoples' memories of seeing abstract works by Shanghai artist Wu Dayu (吴大羽 1903-1988) have been passed down.[160]

Last, American abstract artist Mark Tobey's abstract works were possibly shown to Shanghai artists. Tobey made abstract drawings in ink during his trip to China and Japan in 1934 (possibly in Hong Kong and/or Shanghai). Considering that Tobey took regular calligraphy lessons from Shanghai painter Teng Baiye (滕白也 1900-1980) and was invited to meet with members of the Baihai society, there is high chance that they viewed Tobey's artworks.[161] This series of clues offers quite convincing evidence that abstract art was known to the Shanghai art world, at least to some selected artists.

It is unfortunate not be able to see the actual Republican abstract works, but fundamental elements of abstract art are still traceable through works of 1930s-era Shanghai modernist artists. This is because when realistic oil paintings were being canonized to be the ideal model of new Chinese art, some radical Shanghai artists took the opposite notion. They abandoned mimetic representation and experimented with

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[159] Guan Liang 关良, *Memoir of Guan Liang* [Guan Liang huiyilu 关良回忆录] (Shanghai: Shanghai shuhua chubanshe, 1984), 21.

[160] Zhao Chuan, *History of Shanghai Abstraction*, 12-13.

[161] David Clarke conducted a study about Teng Baiye and Mark Tobey. Clarke found that Teng Baiye studied sculpture in Seattle from 1924 to 1927, and there he met Mark Tobey. He assumed that Teng gave Tobey lessons in Chinese brushwork at some point in the 1920s. David Clarke, "Cross-cultural Dialogue and Artistic Innovation: Teng Baiye and Mark Tobey," in *Shanghai Modern 1919-1945*, ed. Jo-Anne Birnie Danzker, Ken Lum, Zheng Shengtian (Ostfildern-Ruit: Hatje Cantz, 2004), 95.